[1] Thijs Slegers is a Dutch journalist who went from a successful career as a football journalist at Voetbal International magazine to become the spokesperson of PSV Eindhoven football club in 2015. Before his death, Slegers managed to unite around 40,000 donors around one cause: helping people who need blood and stem cell.

[2] At the end of 2020, Slegers was diagnosed with severe leukemia, or blood cancer, and had to adapt his responsibilities at the club to undergo medical treatment. After two years of treatment, on 2 February 2023, Slegers announced in a public statement that his disease was incurable. "The doctors can do nothing more for me," he said on a social media platform.

[3] Despite sharing **this sad news** with the world, Slegers did not lose his sense of humor, asking fans for recommendations of TV series to watch. He also didn't forget to think of other people who are suffering from leukemia. Slegers made a special request at the end of his media announcement: "If you really want to make me happy, register as a blood or cell donor. I can't receive any more help, but other cancer patients can! This will make me really satisfied."

[4] The reaction of clubs, journalists, fans and the entire football world was one of total support and solidarity with Slegers, but **he** never imagined what would happen with his request. In less than one day, Matchis Foundation, which administers blood and cell donations in the Netherlands, received around 400 new donors who responded to Slegers' request. A week later, registrations went up to 5000.

[5] In the meantime, PSVs sponsors decided to give up all their advertising space in the stadium during the match between PSV and Groningen to send messages of support and help in Slegers' appeal for more blood and cell donors. In addition, the match paused in the 12th minute to celebrate and thank Slegers with applause, cellphone lights and banners.

[6] "I am very happy about this. It's very special that people come together to do something like this. think it's a wonderful example of the power of football," said Slegers. "We are living in uncertain times filled with conflicts. The power of football brings people together to cross borders, unite and celebrate together," added Slegers.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT.

A. CHOOSE THE BEST TITLE FOR THE TEXT. (1 pt)

a. How Football Unites the World
b. The Suffering of Sick People in Netherlands
c. The Life of a Famous Football Player

The best title is: . . . . . .

D. COMPLETE THE CHART WITH THE RIGHT INFORMATION FROM THE TEXT. (2 pts)

Figures	What they refer to
2015	.....
2023	.....
.....	The number of donors registered after one week of Slegers' request
12th minute	.....

E. ARE THESE STATEMENTS TRUE OR FALSE? JUSTIFY. (3 pts)

1. Slegers started his career as the spokesperson of PSV Eindhoven.

   .....

2. Although Slegers was sick, he still wanted to have fun.

   .....

3. Following Slegers' request, almost 400 people contributed to blood donation on the first day.

   .....

F. ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS. (3 pts)

1. What illness did Slegers suffer from?

   .....

2. How did PSV sponsors respond to Slegers' request?

   .....

3. According to Slegers, what is the power of football?

   .....

G. COMPLETE THE SENTENCES WITH INFORMATION FROM THE TEXT. (2 pts)

1. To undergo medical treatment, Slegers .....

   .....

2. To help other people who are also suffering, Slegers .....

   .....

H. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS THAT MEAN ALMOST THE SAME AS (2 pts)

1. duties (paragraph 2): .....
2. contributors (paragraph 4): .....

I. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO? (2 pts)

1. this sad news (paragraph 3): .....
2. he: (paragraph 4): .....

A. FILL IN THE GAPS WITH THE CORRECT WORDS FROM THE LIST. (2 pts)

innovative - gender - creation - technology - traditional

1. Besides . . . . . equality, there are other women issues which are important in our society.
2. Modern technologies help young people to be . . . . . and develop new skills.

B. CORRECT THE UNDERLINED MISTAKES IN THE SENTENCES. (2 pts)

1. Rob, **whom** father is an engineer, is also a programmer.
   The correct answer: . . . . . .
2. It's exciting to **hearing** that Peter has graduated from his language school.
   The correct answer: . . . . . .

C. PUTTHE WORDSIN BRACKETS INTHE CORRECT FORM. (2 pts)

Sports projects make a direct (contribute) . . . . . to employment and social cohesion. They also make our country economically (sustainability) . . . . . .

D. PUT THE VERBS NI BRACKETS NI THE CORRECT TENSE. (2 pts)

1. Jeff: Have you ever been to Marrakesh?
   Rick: Yes, I have. I (go). . . . . there last spring.
2. By 2050, engineers (develop) . . . . . more sophisticated Al tools.

E. REWRITE THE SENTENCES AS INDICATED. (3 pts)

1. Our school published the second issue of the magazine last month.
   The second issue of the magazine . . . . . .
2. "We will help farmers in al regions of the country," said the minister.
   The minister said . . . . . .
3. It was raining heavily. Nevertheless, we played the match.
   Although . . . . . .

F. MATCH EACH EXPRESSION WITH ITS APPROPRIATE FUNCTION. (2 pts)

Expressions	Functions
1. "If only I had saved more money! I could have afforded the trip to Spain."	a. Expressing good news
2. "Can you please tell me how to deal with this problem?"	b. Expressing certainty
3. "I see what you mean, but I think processed food is unhealthy."	c. Expressing regret
4. "Artificial Intelligence definitely helps a lot today."	d. Disagreeing
	e. Asking for advice

Answers: 1 . . . . . 2 . . . . . 3 . . . . . 4 . . . . .

G. COMPLETE THE FOLLOWING EXCHANGES APPROPRIATELY. (2 pts)

1. Yassine: I think inflation is a serious economic problem.
   Malak: (Asks for clarification) . . . . . .
2. Suzie: (Apologizes to Nora for not completing the project on time. . . . . .
   . . . . . .
   Nora: No worries dear, we still have two days to finish it.

DO TASKS 1 AND 2

TASK 1: Complete the following paragraph (4 pts)

I help my parents at home in different ways. First, ...

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

TASK 2: (6 pts)

Write a reply to the following email which is sent by a parent to a school advisor.

Dear advisor,
Our son refuses to do his homework or revise his lessons. Once he gets back from school, he starts playing games or watching TV. What do you think we should do so that he would spend more time on his schoolwork? What do you suggest?

Amine's parents

Dear parents,

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

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KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Baccalaureate English National Exam Humanities July 2025 · Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

A. Choose the best title for the text. (1 pt) a. How Football Unites the World

B. Complete the chart with the right information from the text. (2 pts) **5000** (registrations went up to 5000 a week later).
12th minute → the match paused to celebrate and thank Slegers with applause, cellphone lights and banners.

C. Are these statements true or false? Justify. (3 pts)

1. **False.** He started as a football journalist at Voetbal International before becoming PSV's spokesperson in 2015. (paragraph 1)
2. **True.** He "did not lose his sense of humor, asking fans for recommendations of TV series to watch." (paragraph 3)
3. **True.** In less than one day, Matchis Foundation "received around 400 new donors." (paragraph 4)

D. Answer these questions. (3 pts)

1. Severe leukemia (blood cancer).
2. They gave up all their advertising space in the stadium during the match to send messages of support and help in his appeal for more donors.
3. It brings people together to cross borders, unite and celebrate together.

E. Complete the sentences with information from the text. (2 pts)

1. …had to adapt his responsibilities at the club.
2. …asked people to register as blood or cell donors.

F. Find in the text words that mean almost the same as: (2 pts)

1. responsibilities
2. donors

G. What do the underlined words in the text refer to? (2 pts)

1. That his disease was incurable
2. Slegers

II. LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

A. Fill in the gaps with the correct words from the list. (2 pts) gender · innovative

B. Correct the underlined mistakes in the sentences. (2 pts)

1. whose
2. hear

C. Put the words in brackets in the correct form. (2 pts) contribution · sustainable

D. Put the verbs in brackets in the correct tense. (2 pts) went · will have developed

E. Rewrite the sentences as indicated. (3 pts)

1. The second issue of the magazine **was published by our school last month**.
2. The minister said **that they would help farmers in all regions of the country**.
3. Although **it was raining heavily, we played the match**.

F. Match each expression with its appropriate function. (2 pts)

1. Expressing regret
2. Asking for advice
3. Disagreeing
4. Expressing certainty

G. Complete the following exchanges appropriately. (2 pts)

1. Sorry, what do you mean by inflation? Could you explain it, please?
2. I'm really sorry for not completing the project on time.

III. WRITING (10 POINTS; task 1: 4 pts; task 2: 6 pts)

Scoring criteria	Task 1	Task 2
Relevance of content to the task	2 pts	3 pts
Appropriateness and variety of vocabulary	1 pt	2 pts
Grammar and mechanics	1 pt	1 pt

Model answers (any appropriate answer is accepted)

Task 1: I help my parents at home in different ways. First, I tidy my room and help my mother prepare meals. Second, I wash the dishes after dinner and take out the rubbish. In addition, I go shopping with my father at the weekend and carry the bags. Finally, I help my younger brother with his homework. I like helping them because it makes our home a happy place.

Task 2: Dear parents, Thank you for your email. Many teenagers have the same problem, so please do not worry. First, I suggest that you set a fixed timetable: Amine should do his homework before playing games or watching TV. Second, you should limit the time he spends on screens, for example one hour a day. Moreover, you could prepare a quiet place for him to study and sit with him at the beginning. Finally, talk to him kindly and praise him when he works hard. If the problem continues, please come to see me at school.
Best regards,
The school advisor